



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Too much stress ... Time to take a holiday!



Learning Outcome

Describe past experiences in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Do you feel relaxed? Stressed?
- When was the last time you went on a holiday? Where did you go?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about past experiences.
- I can use past time expressions.
- I can talk about interests.





Let's Explore!

Sally **sort of*** finished packing ... Time to chill out with Vanessa one last time!

* "Sort of" means quite, almost.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Vanessa: Hey, Sally. Thanks for coming. Did you finish packing?
Sally: Sort of ... I can buy what I need when I get to Paris.
Vanessa: Yeah, I guess so ... Was this a last-minute decision?
Sally: I had the idea a while ago, but I didn't have the money!
Vanessa: \$1 million makes everything possible!
Sally: Yeah ... More time to relax ...
Vanessa: When was the last time you traveled?
Sally: Three years ago. What about you?
Vanessa: I visited my Aunt Nelly last year.
Sally: Was that in San Francisco?
Vanessa: Yes. I love the pace of that city.
Sally: Yeah, people love to chill out.
Vanessa: Mexico is the same. I went there in 2012. The people were so relaxed!
Sally: Who needs stress, right? So ... should I tell the boys?
Vanessa: It's up to you ...





Let's Practice!

Sally and Vanessa love to travel. What do they like about it?

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Write each word in the correct order.

1. traveled?/was/the/last/When/time/you _____
2. last/Aunt/my/visited/Nelly/I/year. _____
3. ?/Was/in/that/Francisco/San _____
4. pace/city./that/love/of/the/I _____
5. out./love/people/to/chill/Yeah, _____
6. so/were/people/The/relaxed! _____



Let's Practice!

When was the last time you went on a holiday? Let's practice speaking!

*Instructions: Read the sentences. Fill in the blank with the missing word. Use: **last, while, 2012, last-minute, year, years ago, agoes, whiles, lasted.***

1. When was the _____ time you traveled?
2. Three _____. What about you?
3. I visited my Aunt Nelly last _____.
4. I went there in _____.
5. Was this a _____ decision?
6. I had the idea a _____ ago, but I didn't have the money.





Extension Activity

When was the last time you ... ? Let's talk about the past!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think of 5 interesting activities, like *go to the movies*.
- Ask your partner 5 questions in the past. Start with "*When was the last time you ... ?*"
- Use past time expressions to answer the questions.
- Use the chart below to write your partner's answers.
- Answer your partner's questions.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write 5 sentences using the Simple Past tense.

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I use expressions like *a while ago*.

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I talk about interests.

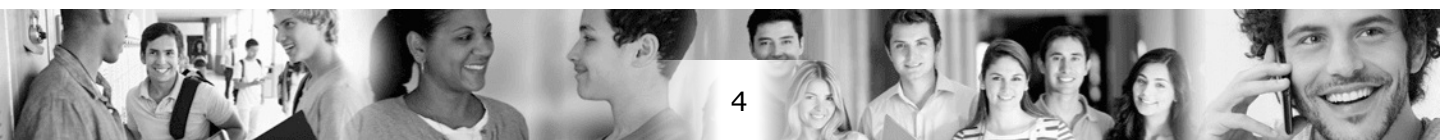
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When was the last time you ... ?	Answer



Target Words

- to chill out** (verb): to relax and enjoy free time
e.g. It's Friday night! Time to chill out!
- up to you** (expression): you decide
e.g. **Ann**: Should I tell them? **Bob**: It's up to you.
- to relax** (verb): to reduce work or other activities
e.g. I really need to relax more.
- a while ago** (expression): some time in the past
e.g. I bought my ticket a while ago.
- last-minute decision** (expression): something you do without a lot of planning
e.g. This trip was a last-minute decision.
- pace** (noun): rhythm; speed
e.g. I like the pace of New York City.
- stress** (noun): situations that make you feel worried or anxious
e.g. There is too much stress at work right now.





Learning Points

Past Time Expressions

You use expressions like *three years ago* or *last year* when you talk about the past.

You use expressions like *in 2012* when you talk about a year in the past.

Expression	Example
in ... (month or year)	<i>Did you go to Mexico in 2012?</i>
last ... (day, month, time, etc.)	<i>I didn't visit my Aunt Nelly last year.</i>
(number of months or years) ... ago	<i>I bought my ticket 3 weeks ago.</i>

The Simple Past tense

The Simple Past talks about completed, finished actions that could be at any time in the past.

You use Past Time Expressions when you want to say **when** something happened.

Look at the chart to review the Simple Past tense in its different forms:

Affirmative	Negative	Interrogative
Subject + verb + ed	Subject + did not + infinitive without to	Did + subject + infinitive without to
Vanessa visited her aunt last year.	Vanessa did not visit her aunt last year.	Did Vanessa visit her aunt last year?

